Early Grades Achievement Strategic Issue: Early Reading Proficiency

Goal: Increase the percentage of Brannock County third graders reading at College and Career Ready levels on the state reading assessment from 31% in spring 2023 to 80% by spring 2032.

> *The years from kindergarten through third grade are when children learn to read. Every year after that, they read to learn.*

In 2015, The Wexmoor Foundation brought together leaders from local foundations, businesses, Brannock County Schools, county government and the public library to discuss a hard fact: only about one-third of the county's third graders were reading on grade level. Research shows that third grade reading is a strong predictor of high school graduation and later success.

That conversation led to a Third Grade Reading Task Force, which spent a year reviewing research and past community efforts and defining the goal and scope of a community-wide early literacy effort. In 2016, the Task Force became the founding board of Read Brannock.

Read Brannock's work centers on five levers: great reading instruction, engaged families, books in every home, high-quality tutoring, and summer reading. The Foundation supports this strategic issue in five primary ways:

Board service	Lead funding	Aligned funding	Strategic guidance	Sharing lessons
The Executive Director serves on the Read Brannock board.	The Foundation is a committed lead funder of Read Brannock operations.	Within Early Grades Achievement, literacy grants align to Read Brannock priorities.	Board members and staff serve as thought partners to Read Brannock leadership.	The Foundation shares lessons from Read Brannock with state-level partners.

From The Wexmoor Foundation Impact Plan: approved by the Board May 14, 2019; revised August 2025